

PRESSURIZED Public Presentation Materials

Project Title

PRESSURIZED

One-Sentence Description

PRESSURIZED is a tactile arcade experience in which players pilot a submarine through a chaotic underwater world by operating a massive hand-built panel of real switches, dials, levers, and buttons in response to on-screen command prompts.

Extended Description (for signage or printed materials)

PRESSURIZED is a complete arcade unit: a Unity-developed submarine game played not with a conventional controller, but with a hand-fabricated control deck packed with over 30 physical inputs- faucet valves, hand wheels, toggle switches, a telephone handset, a stapler, a numeric keypad, and more. Each module is labeled with absurd names laser-etched into the control surface. The game responds in real time to physical input, while LED lighting, alarm sirens, and dynamic audio react to gameplay events. Players must react to command prompts, manage steam pressure, and battle boss creatures, all while managing a submarine that is perpetually on the edge of failure. The full cabinet, controller, and game were designed, built, and programmed entirely by one student over the course of a single academic year.

Credits

Created by: Holden Denyer

Program: Immersive Media Design, University of Maryland

Hardware Consultation: Matthew Nolan, Sound Design. Yael Inbar, Gameplay Design. Jeremy Kunkel, Metal Art.

Presented at the Immersive Media Design Capstone Showcase, May 8, 2026

Audience Instructions

Step up to the cabinet and press the BIG RED BUTTON to begin.

A short tutorial will introduce the game mechanics before your first round.

Read the command prompts on screen and locate the matching module on the control panel.

Interact with the correct input as quickly as possible. Faster responses earn higher scores.

Watch the submarine view: maintain steam gauge pressure and watch out for incoming enemy encounters. Pick up the phone when it rings!

Defend the vessel by pressing the grid button corresponding to where boss creatures appear on screen.

Two or more players can play side by side, dividing command prompts and consistent inputs.

The game ends when all three lives are lost.

Content Notes

PRESSURIZED is designed for players of all ages. Visual and audio cues include flashing red alarm lights and intermittent alarm sounds. Players with sensory sensitivities should be aware of these elements. The game includes a colorblind-accessible color scheme tested with colorblind users during development.

Poster

The PRESSURIZED showcase poster features original underwater game art depicting aquatic creatures including an octopus, crab, and cow (yes, a cow) against a seabed background. The PRESSURIZED logo appears at top in the project's custom industrial typeface. The poster lists the showcase date, time, and location, and includes a QR code linking to additional project documentation.

Poster tagline: A Tactile Arcade Experience by Holden Denyer

File included in submission folder as 'PRESSURIZED_PresentationPoster'